

JUNE 12 – 18, 2026 · 6 NIGHTS

## Our Southwest Trip

Greg, Keren, Shai & Ori · one rental car

Las Vegas → Big Pine → Goldfield → Cathedral Gorge → Cedar City → Zion →  
Mesquite → Las Vegas

### ✈ Flights — all four of us (Southwest)

OUT · GREG

**ARRAYVP**

OUT · KEREN

**ARBMY8**

OUT · SHAI

**ARCVUG**

OUT · ORI

**ARRAYVP**

RETURN · GREG+ORI

**ARQ380**

RETURN · SHAI

**AWZNU8**

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OUTBOUND JUN 12

**WN974 · BWI 9:35a → LAS 11:35a**

RETURN JUN 18

**WN235 · LAS 12:10p → BWI 7:50p**

NOTE

Shai = companion; unaccompanied-minor + assistance requested

### Rental car (Thrifty · Las Vegas airport)

CONFIRMATION

**631118374**

VEHICLE

**Dodge Ram 1500 or similar**

PICK-UP

Fri Jun 12, 11:00a · LAS

DROP-OFF

Thu Jun 18 (see note)

THRIFTY PHONE

1-877-283-0898

PICKUP

Level 0 → Ground Transp. → McCarran Rent-A-Car shuttle

⚠ **Fix this:** The voucher currently shows drop-off **Wed Jun 17, 10:00a** — but our hotels and flights run through **Thu Jun 18**. The car needs extending to Jun 18 or we'll be without a vehicle for Mesquite and the airport run. Call Thrifty (1-877-283-0898) to confirm.

## Las Vegas

### Day 1

Friday, June 12 · Fly in, magic show, drive to Big Pine

TRAVEL

Land late morning, grab the rental, catch an afternoon magic show on the Strip, then drive north into the Eastern Sierra for the night in Big Pine.

- **11:35a** Land at Las Vegas (LAS) — all four on WN974

Touchdown in Las Vegas. Baggage claim is on Level 0 (ground level). Follow signs for Ground Transportation to reach the Thrifty rental car shuttle.

**Tip:** Allow 45–60 min for bags + rental car pickup. The airport is large but well-signed. Look for blue "Rental Car" signs immediately past baggage claim.

- **~12p** Pick up the Thrifty car

Take the rental car shuttle from Level 0 → Ground Transportation to the **Thrifty** Rent-A-Car Center.

⚠ **Confirm on pickup:** the voucher shows drop-off Wed Jun 17 — verify at the counter that it's been extended to Thu Jun 18. Confirmation: **631118374**.

● **2:00p** Nathan Burton Comedy Magic Show (to 3:10p) ▼

Award-winning 70-minute Vegas magic and comedy show at **FlyOver Las Vegas** on the Strip — [nathanburton.com](https://nathanburton.com). Large-scale illusions, fast humor, and audience participation make this one of Las Vegas's most kid-pleasing afternoon shows.

- Large-scale stage illusions and dramatic disappearing acts
- Audience participation moments — one of your kids may get called up
- Comedy routines between magic segments keep the pace snappy
- Arrive 15 min early for the best VIP seats

**Logistics:** 3771 Las Vegas Blvd S. Theater is fully air-conditioned. Order # **FTHXXL** · Booking # **353315109** · Entry via QR / mobile wallet.

Nathan Burton Magic Show

● **Aft.** Drive LAS → Big Pine via US-95 & US-6 (~5 hr 15 min, ~260 mi) ▼

A sweeping high-desert drive north through Nevada before crossing into the Eastern Sierra. US-95 N cuts through the Mojave and up through Beatty and Amargosa Valley before connecting to US-6 W toward Bishop and Big Pine.

- **Gas + snack stop: Beatty, NV** (~100 miles from LAS, ~1.5 hr) — good services, last busy stop for a while
- US-6 W toward Bishop passes through stunning open basin-and-range landscape
- Dramatic transition: Nevada high desert → Eastern Sierra peaks
- Arrive Big Pine ~8:30–9pm — plan dinner in Bishop (15 min north, **Mountain Rambler Brewery** open till 10p)

**Tip:** Fill the tank in Beatty. The stretch into Bishop has limited services. Bishop has a **Vons** and **Grocery Outlet** — worth a stop tonight or first thing tomorrow morning to stock the kitchen at the lodge.

● **Eve.** Check in — The Palisades Lodge, Big Pine ▼

Your home for nights 1–2. Full kitchen in the room — stock it in Bishop for easy breakfasts. Quiet mountain-view setting in a small Eastern Sierra town.

**Logistics:** 110 N Main St, Big Pine, CA · Confirmation **5567.400.664** · PIN **3471** · +1 760 937 1340. Checkout revised to Sun Jun 14 — confirm lodge has this on file.

**SHOW · 4 VIP SEATS**

**Nathan Burton Magic Show**

ORDER #

**FTHXXL**

BOOKING #

**353315109**

TIME

2:00–3:10p

ENTRY

QR / mobile wallet

**🏠 LODGING · NIGHTS 1–2**

**The Palisades Lodge of Big Pine**

CONFIRMATION

**5567.400.664**

PIN

**3471**

CHECK-OUT

Sun Jun 14 (revised)

ADDRESS

110 N Main St, Big Pine, CA

PHONE

+1 760 937 1340

**Confirm:** Booking still prints a Jun 15 checkout — verify the lodge has the revised **Jun 14** on file.

**EAT**

Arriving late in Big Pine — grab dinner on the road or in Bishop (15 min north).

**Mountain Rambler Brewery** (Bishop) is open till 10p for burgers/salads.

**Breakfast:** Palisades Lodge has no breakfast, but the room has a full kitchen — plan a grocery run in Bishop (Vons, 1190 N Main St or Grocery Outlet, 1320 N Main St) for in-room breakfasts.

## Eastern Sierra

### Days 2–3

Sat–Sun, June 13–14 · Family time near Bishop

FAMILY

Two open days in the Owens Valley with family — no fixed schedule. The high Sierra is right there: alpine lakes, ancient bristlecone pines, or just a relaxed valley day.

- Bishop Creek Canyon & the Alpine Lakes

#### Bishop Creek Canyon / Owens Valley

Just 20 miles west of Bishop, Highway 168 climbs into a spectacular canyon ending at three crystal-clear alpine lakes between 9,000 and 10,200 feet. The paved road means no serious hiking required — you can drive to the water's edge and picnic with the Sierra Nevada towering on all sides.

- **South Lake** — highest and most dramatic; rocky shoreline, stunning Sierra views
- **Lake Sabrina** — accessible fishing pier, café with homemade pie and ice cream
- **North Lake** — quieter, beautiful aspen groves surrounding the shore
- Allow 3–4 hours: scenic drive up + picnic + explore the shoreline

**Tips:** Bring layers — elevation is 15–20°F cooler than the valley. Kids may feel the altitude (9,000 ft) — slow down, drink extra water. Pack a picnic from **Schat's Bakkerij** or **Pupfish Cafe** in Bishop. Road is paved but winding — take it easy.

- Ancient Bristlecone Pine Forest (optional day trip) ✓

## Ancient Bristlecone Pine Forest

90 minutes from Big Pine in the **White Mountains**, this forest holds the world's oldest living trees — some over 4,800 years old, older than the Egyptian pyramids. The short Discovery Trail and visitor center make it accessible for young kids, and there's something genuinely mind-bending about standing next to a tree that was already ancient when Rome was founded.

- **Discovery Trail** — short, easy loop perfect for kids; gnarled, twisted ancient trees unlike anything else
- **Schulman Grove Visitor Center** — exhibits explaining the trees' astonishing age
- Ranger talks at 11am & 2pm in summer — great for curious kids
- Sweeping views of the Owens Valley 5,000 feet below

**Tips:** 10,000 ft elevation — bring jackets (40–60°F up there), drink extra water, and take it slow. Allow 4–5 hours total including driving. **Skip the Methuselah Trail** (4.2 mi on exposed ridge — too long for young kids). Visitor center hours ~10am–4:30pm.

- Stock the cooler before leaving Bishop ✓

The stretch from Bishop to Cedar City crosses a long, sparse stretch of Nevada desert (Goldfield → Tonopah → Cathedral Gorge) with very limited food options. A well-loaded cooler is essential.

- **Erick Schat's Bakker**y — shepherd bread + sandwiches make perfect road food
- **Pupfish Cafe** — pack-out salads and fresh items for day-of eating
- **Vons (1190 N Main)** or **Grocery Outlet (1320 N Main)** for drinks, snacks, fruit

**Plan:** You'll eat from this cooler at Cathedral Gorge on Monday (no food at that park). Pack enough for 2 full days of snacks plus one picnic lunch.

Both nights covered by the Palisades Lodge booking above (revised checkout Sun Jun 14).

## EAT — BISHOP (THE BEST FOOD TOWN OF THE TRIP)

**Pupfish Cafe** — healthiest pick: build-your-own plates, avocado toast, salmon, salads. Breakfast/lunch, closed Wed.

**The Rolling Chef 395** — 4.9★ food truck, fresh fish/shrimp tacos, fresh cucumber juice. Weekdays only.

**Cloudripper** — local-sourced pop-up at Owens Valley Distillery (Thu–Sat eve) — bibimbap, noodles. Check their IG first.

**Mountain Rambler Brewery** — reliable daily sit-down: burgers, salads, Brussels sprouts.

**Erick Schat's Bakery** — famous stop; grab sheepherder bread & sandwiches here for the drive days ahead.

**Stock up before you leave Bishop:** the next two days cross long empty stretches (Goldfield, Tonopah, Cathedral Gorge) with few options. Load a cooler with sandwiches, fruit, water — Schat's bread + Pupfish make a great picnic kit.

## Goldfield Nevada

### Day 3

Sunday, June 14 · Bishop → Goldfield (evening drive)

#### TRAVEL

Spend the day with family, then leave Bishop in the evening and cross into Nevada's high desert — arriving late in Goldfield, a half-living ghost mining town.

#### ● **Day** Family time near Bishop; pack up, check out of Palisades

Final morning in the Eastern Sierra. A last hike, a leisurely breakfast at Pupfish, or a bakery run at Schat's for road provisions. Check out of Palisades Lodge by the posted checkout time.

**Before you leave:** Stock the cooler at Vons or Grocery Outlet — nothing's open late in Goldfield and the Nevada desert stretch ahead has sparse options.

#### ● **Eve.** Drive Bishop → Goldfield (~2 hr 9 min)

Head south on US-395, then east on US-6 toward Tonopah, then south on US-95 to Goldfield. Beautiful high-desert drive — open skies, volcanic ridgelines, and the haunting emptiness of the Great Basin.

- Fill gas in Bishop before departing
- Tonopah (~halfway) has gas if needed
- Eat dinner in Bishop before leaving — nothing's open late in Goldfield

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● **Late** Arrive Goldfield — self check-in

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Self-check-in with the door code means late arrival is no problem at all. The Airbnb has a full kitchen. Your host is Michael.

**Finding it:** Don't use Apple Maps — GPS **37.703255, -117.231164**. Northbound Hwy 95, right on Crystal Ave entering town, 2 blocks, house on the right. Door code: **2 6 8 2** · WiFi: Radar Guest / summerplace

🏠 **LODGING · NIGHT 3**

**Eclectic Desert Home — Goldfield (Airbnb, host Michael)**

CONFIRMATION

**HMKZKM8NSY**

DOOR CODE

**2 6 8 2**

CHECK-OUT

Mon Jun 15, 11:00a

WIFI

Radar Guest / summerplace

**EAT — GOLDFIELD (TINY)**

You arrive late — eat dinner before leaving Bishop or bring your cooler provisions. Nothing's open late here.

**Dinky Diner** — the one real gem (4.5★): fresh home-cooked breakfast in an 1800s building. Opens 8:15a — great quick breakfast before Monday's drive.

**Closed Sun** — tomorrow (Monday) is fine ✓

**Breakfast:** The Goldfield Airbnb has a kitchen — but with an early Monday start, Dinky Diner is the easy, fun option right in town.

## Day 4

Monday, June 15 · Goldfield → Tonopah → Cathedral Gorge → Cedar City

### TRAVEL

A big day with three memorable stops: a graffiti car-art field, a climbable ghost-mine, and eerie slot-canyon caves — ending at the mini animal farm outside Cedar City.

#### ● Morning International Car Forest of the Last Church

One of America's most gloriously weird roadside attractions: 40+ junked cars balanced nose-first in the Nevada desert, every surface painted in wild, constantly-changing graffiti art. It's free, bizarre, and right next to your Airbnb — the kids will find this genuinely hilarious. ([Atlas Obscura](#))

- Cars stacked and angled in gravity-defying positions, some 20+ feet in the air
- Every vehicle covered in colorful murals, skulls, characters, and abstract art
- Open grounds to wander and get up close — no fence, no rules
- Great photo ops: find the most creative car and do a family shot in front of it
- Free, open 24/7 — 20–30 min is all you need

**Tips:** Right on Crystal Ave next to your Airbnb — you can almost walk there. Use the Airbnb bathroom first (no facilities on site). Go early before the desert heat builds. The art changes constantly so no two visits look the same.

International Car Forest

#### ● ~11a Check out Goldfield; drive north to Tonopah

Tonopah is 27 miles north on US-95 (~30 min). Catch breakfast at [Dinky Diner](#) before checkout — it opens at 8:15am and it's genuinely great.

**Dinky Diner:** 4.5★, fresh home-cooked breakfast in an 1800s building, right in town. Opens 8:15a, closed Sundays — today is Monday ✓. Don't miss it.

● **Late a.m.** Tonopah Historic Mining Park

## Tonopah Historic Mining Park

A sprawling 113-acre outdoor museum on the original silver claims that made Tonopah the "Queen of the Silver Camps." Self-guided tours let you wander freely past original mine headframes, century-old buildings, and towering mining equipment. Far more engaging than an indoor museum for young kids — it's a big open space to explore at their own pace.

- Original mine headframes and headhouses, many you can walk right up to
- Authentic ore carts, machinery, and processing equipment scattered throughout
- Multiple restored mine buildings and ruins to explore
- Great elevated views over Tonopah from the hilltop park grounds
- Self-guided: go at your own pace, leave when you're ready

**Tips: Kids 7 & under FREE** · Adults \$5 · Open 9am–5pm (behind the [Mizpah Hotel](#)). Allow 1.5–2 hours. Bring water and sunscreen — very exposed. Guided Polaris off-road tours also available: call 775-482-9274 ext 6 (8am–4pm) to reserve.

● **Aft.** Continue east to Cathedral Gorge (included in the ~3 hr 30 min total)

From Tonopah, head east on US-6 toward Ely, then south on US-93 to Panaca, NV. This stretch of Nevada highway is quiet and dramatic — wide-open basin-and-range landscape with almost no traffic.

**Tip:** This is a good time to eat from your Bishop cooler in the car. No food at Cathedral Gorge — the shaded ramadas at the park are your lunch spot.

● **Late aft.** Cathedral Gorge State Park

## Cathedral Gorge State Park

Ancient lakebed sediment eroded over millions of years into a surreal landscape of cathedral-like clay spires, slot canyon mazes, and cave-like formations. One of Nevada's most underrated parks — and the narrow crawl-through tunnels make it genuinely thrilling for young kids. (NV State Parks)

- Slot canyon maze — wander between towering pink and tan clay formations up to 30 feet tall
- **Crawl-through "rabbit hole" tunnels** — a highlight kids remember for years; narrow passages that pop you out into open spaces
- Easy 1-mile loop trails through the canyon — totally manageable for young kids
- Shaded picnic ramadas at the entrance (perfect for your cooler lunch)
- Wildlife: lizards sunning on rocks, ravens, occasional raptors overhead

**Tips:** \$10/vehicle. Flat, easy walking — very accessible for young kids. Allow 1–1.5 hours. Restrooms at the entrance. Late afternoon visit avoids peak heat. Keep kids away from unstable clay walls. Watch for loose soil in the slot sections.

### ● **Eve.** Drive to Mini Animal Farm, Cedar City (~1 hr 28 min)

South on US-93, then west on I-15 toward St. George and Cedar City. The farm sits right on the Cathedral Gorge → Zion line — a perfectly placed overnight.

**Finding the farm:** Address won't resolve — use Google pin: **37.5559346, -113.1816901**. From St. George (NB I-15): Exit 42, right off exit, left on Old Hwy 91, 6 mi through Kanarraville to Bumblebee Spring Rd, left ½ mi, right through the gate. Only home on the north side — Unit #2. Host cell: 435-862-6342.

### **LODGING · NIGHTS 4–5**

## **Farm House #2, Mini Animal Farm — Cedar City (Airbnb, host Brandon)**

CONFIRMATION

**HM4EJ5NAR5**

CHECK-OUT

Wed Jun 17, 10:00a

GOOGLE PIN

**37.5559346, -113.1816901**

HOST CELL

435-862-6342

#### EAT — ALONG THE WAY

**Tonopah (lunch): Tonopah Brewing Co.** (salads + BBQ, non-alcoholic options, kid-friendly, daily) or **Strawberry Hill Diner** (4.6★, fresh, closed Tue).

**Cathedral Gorge (picnic):** no food at the park — eat your **cooler provisions** in the shaded picnic ramadas. This is where the Bishop sandwiches earn their keep.

**Cedar City (dinner): Bunnisa's Thai** (4.7★, gluten-free & veg options, closed Sun) or **Tony's Diner** (smoothies + açai + fresh sandwiches).

**Park-food note:** Bring water + snacks into Cathedral Gorge (summer heat, no concessions). Refill water in Cedar City for the next day's Zion trip.

## Zion National Park

### Day 5

Tuesday, June 16 · Zion National Park (day trip)

PARK DAY

The crown jewel. A day trip from the farm into Zion — towering sandstone, the Virgin River, and the best hot-day family hike in any national park.

- **Early** Drive Cedar City farm → Zion (Springdale) (~50 min) 

Take I-15 S to UT-17 S, then UT-9 W through the dramatic Zion–Mt. Carmel Tunnel into the canyon. No checkout today — you're back at the farm tonight. ([Zion NPS site](#))

**Tip:** Leave by 7–7:30am. Park entry is **\$35/vehicle** (7-day pass). Head to the Visitor Center first to get a map and check the shuttle schedule. Crowds build rapidly after 9am — the earlier the better.

- **Midday** Zion shuttle + Riverside Walk into the Narrows 

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## Riverside Walk / Zion Narrows

Zion's most iconic family walk: a paved 2.2-mile path following the Virgin River deep into the canyon, where the walls rise 1,000 feet straight overhead. At the trail's end, kids can wade in the cool, crystal-clear river — one of the best hot-day activities in any national park, and genuinely magical.

- Board the free shuttle at the Visitor Center → ride to **Stop 9 (Temple of Sinawava)**
- Walk the flat, paved Riverside Walk (2.2 mi round trip) along the river
- Reach the Narrows entry and wade in the cool Virgin River (~55°F — refreshingly cold in June heat)
- You can turn back at any point — no need to commit to the full wading hike
- Canyon walls provide shade through most of the walk

**Tips:** This stop gets packed by 10am — go first thing. Bring water shoes or old sneakers for the river wading. The paved walk is stroller-accessible. The full Narrows wading hike beyond the paved section involves icy water up to your waist and slippery rocks — the paved section gives you the views without the challenge. That's the right call with young kids. ([NPS trail info](#))

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### ● **Aft.** Emerald Pools or the Pa'rus Trail

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## Emerald Pools / Zion National Park

Two great afternoon options depending on how much energy is left. Lower Emerald Pool delivers a waterfall payoff in just 0.6 miles. Pa'rus Trail is flat, paved, and river-level — perfect if the kids are tired but you want to stay in the park a bit longer.

- **Lower Emerald Pool** (0.6 mi RT, Shuttle Stop 5 / Zion Lodge): a quick, shaded walk to a waterfall dripping into a shimmering pool — satisfying and short

→ **Pa'rus Trail** (up to 3.5 mi RT from Visitor Center): completely flat, paved, stroller-accessible river walk; multiple spots to dip feet in the Virgin River; dogs and bikes welcome

**Tips:** Do Emerald Pool first while energy is up (shuttle to Stop 5). Save Pa'rus Trail for winding down in the late afternoon — it starts at the Visitor Center so you can just walk back when done. Both have much shorter shuttle lines than the Narrows stop. Carry plenty of water.

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● **Tip** June heat strategy at Zion

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June in Zion Canyon hits 95–100°F in open areas. The good news: most of the best family activities are shaded by canyon walls or along the cool river.

- Start before 8am — canyon temps are 10–15°F cooler in the morning
- The Narrows is your best friend: canyon walls provide shade, river keeps you cool
- Midday break (11am–2pm): rest in Springdale, lunch at Oscar's Cafe or FeelLove Coffee
- Return for Emerald Pools in late afternoon when crowds thin
- Bring 1.5+ liters of water per person — refill at Zion Lodge on the shuttle loop

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● **Eve.** Drive back to Mini Animal Farm (~50 min)

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Reverse your morning route back to the farm. The kids get the animals again — miniature Highland cows, goats, and alpacas — before bed. You skip packing up for another day.

🚗 Second night at the **Mini Animal Farm** (covered by the Nights 4–5 booking above). The kids get the animals morning and evening, and you skip packing up.

**EAT — SPRINGDALE / ZION**

**Before the park:** **FeelLove Coffee** opens 6a — coffee, vegan/GF baked goods, and healthy grab-and-go. Or **The Park House** (4.8★ breakfast, fresh fruit & omelets) if you want a sit-down start.

**Dinner:** **Oscar's Cafe** — the Zion institution (daily 7a–9p, vegan items, big salads, sweet potato fries, patio) or **Whiptail Grill** for fresh Mexican.

**Bring lunch into Zion:** there's only one café (Zion Lodge) inside the park and it's busy. Grab sandwiches + lots of water at **FeelLove** or **Sol Foods** (995 Zion Park Blvd,

daily 7a–11p) before you board the shuttle — June is hot and the Narrows/Riverside walk has no food. Pack more water than you think.

## Valley of Fire State Park

### Day 6

Wednesday, June 17 · Cedar City → Valley of Fire → Mesquite

#### TRAVEL

Check out of the farm and drop south into the Valley of Fire — swirling crimson sandstone, ancient petroglyphs, dinosaur-age dunes turned to stone. End the day in Mesquite.

#### ● 10:00a Check out of Mini Animal Farm

Final animal feeding before checkout. The kids will want more time with the miniature Highland cows — pack the night before to make a smooth 10am departure.

**Tip:** Stock up on snacks and water in Cedar City or St. George before Valley of Fire. There's no food inside the park and June temps regularly exceed 110°F — you'll want 2–3 liters of water per person minimum.

#### ● Morn. Drive toward Valley of Fire (from farm ~2.5 hr)

Head south on I-15 through St. George and Las Vegas toward the Valley of Fire exit northeast of Las Vegas. The park entrance is about 35 miles from the Strip.

**Grocery stop:** St. George (**Smith's**, Walmart) has good options. Load up on water, snacks, and sunscreen before the park — nothing is available inside.

#### ● Midday Valley of Fire State Park

## Valley of Fire State Park — petroglyphs

Nevada's oldest state park, where ancient Jurassic sand dunes turned to vivid crimson sandstone over 150 million years. ([NV State Parks](#)) June heat is extreme (110°F+) so stick to the shortest stops — but even a rapid drive-through with two stops delivers some of the most striking red rock scenery in the Southwest.

- **Atlatl Rock** — climb a short staircase to a panel of 2,000-year-old Ancestral Puebloan petroglyphs. One of the most accessible rock art sites in Nevada.
- **Elephant Rock** — a 0.3-mile loop to a sandstone formation that genuinely looks like an elephant. Quick, flat, and the kids love spotting the shape.
- **Rainbow Vista pullout** — no walking required; panoramic views of banded red, orange, white, and purple rock formations.
- **The Beehives** (near east entrance) — dome-shaped formations visible from the road; stop for 5 min.

⚠ **Heat warning:** June highs regularly exceed 110°F. All trails over 1 mile are **closed May–September**. Visit Atlatl Rock and Elephant Rock before 9:30am or after 4:30pm. Bring 2–3 liters of water per person. Reapply sunscreen every 30 min. Visitor Center (9am–4:30pm) has shade, water, and AC.

### ● **Aft.** Drive Valley of Fire → Mesquite (~1 hr 20 min, ~52 mi)

Exit the park west and pick up I-15 N toward Mesquite. The [Highland Estates Condotel](#) has a pool — perfect for cooling off after the desert heat.

**Dinner tonight:** [Gregory's Mesquite Grill](#) (4.6★) — excellent salmon, great-value early dinner menu. Closed Mon/Tue — open Wed ✓. Skip the smoky casino restaurants with the kids.

### **LODGING · NIGHT 6**

## **Highland Estates Condotel — Mesquite (2-BR Deluxe)**

CONFIRMATION

**6576.052.016**

PIN

**2311**

#### CHECK-OUT

Thu Jun 18, by 11a

#### ADDRESS

555 Highland Dr, Mesquite NV

⚠ **Heat:** Valley of Fire June highs hit 110°F+. Trails over 1 mi are **closed May–Sept**. Stick to short walks & overlooks, go early, carry water.

#### EAT — ALONG THE WAY

**Valley of Fire (picnic):** no food in the park — carry water + snacks for the heat. Big grocery run options in Cedar City or St. George before you arrive.

**Overtown (lunch, 10 min from the park): Salts** — healthiest pick: fresh chicken-rice soup, GF options, in a converted church (daily). Or **La Fonda** for generous fresh Mexican.

**Mesquite (dinner): Gregory's Mesquite Grill** (4.6★, great-value early dinner set menu, excellent salmon; closed Mon/Tue — open Wed for you). Skip the smoky casino diners with the kids.

**Breakfast:** Mesquite Condotel has a kitchen but no included breakfast — fine, since you're up and driving to Vegas Thursday morning.

## Las Vegas Strip

### Day 7

Thursday, June 18 · Mesquite → Vegas → home

#### TRAVEL

Easy final morning. Drive from Mesquite to Las Vegas, drop the car, and fly home — into Baltimore by evening.

- **Morn.** Check out, drive Mesquite → LAS (~1 hr 25 min via I-15) 

Pack the night before for a smooth checkout. I-15 W is a straight shot to Las Vegas — target leaving Mesquite by 8:30am.

**Timeline:** Leave Mesquite 8:30a → arrive LAS ~9:45–10a → return car (~15 min) → shuttle to terminal → check bags → security → gate. A 12:10p departure is very comfortable with this timing.

● **~9:30a** Return the Thrifty car

Return at the Thrifty counter at the McCarran Rent-A-Car Center. The shuttle back to Terminal 1 (Southwest Airlines) runs every few minutes.

**Tip:** Take a quick photo of the car on return — documents the condition at drop-off. Keep your Thrifty receipt. Confirmation: **631118374**.

● **12:10p** Depart Las Vegas — WN235 → BWI

Southwest Flight WN235, Las Vegas (LAS) → Baltimore (BWI). Arriving home at 7:50pm Eastern.

Confirmations: Greg + Ori **ARQ380** · Shai **AWZNU8**

● **7:50p** Arrive Baltimore (BWI)

Home! 7 days, 6 nights, one big desert and canyon loop in the books.

**Tight-ish morning:** A 12:10p flight means leaving Mesquite by ~8:30a to return the car and clear security comfortably. Easy if you pack the night before.

## 7 days · 6 nights · a big desert & canyon loop

All drive times filled in. Open items: confirm Thrifty car extended to Jun 18 · confirm Palisades Jun 14 checkout.